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Argus Nitrogen

Market prices and news

Issue 26-179 | Thursday 10 September 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Urea pushes higher

Urea levels moved up through the week, led by the markets west of Suez, underpinned by escalating hostilities in the Middle East and rising energy costs.

September-October barges in the US pushed into the $450s-460s/st fob by mid-week. While granular urea offers into Brazil jumped, pulling levels up to $455-485/t cfr for the week. Argentina traded at $500/t cfr. There was solid and continued activity in most of Europe, with sales largely focused in the north and western markets, with some sales in Spain and the Black Sea. Egyptian granular urea traded at $505-510/t fob through the week, with a deal later on Thursday at $515/t fob, and Algeria's Sorfert also sold at $515/t fob. Sabic AN sold 30,000t of granular urea in the mid-to-high $440s/t fob Saudi west coast for loading in October.

Markets east of Suez were comparatively more muted, but Chinese granular urea prices moved upwards towards $420/t fob and above on continued tight supply. Southeast Asian granular urea prices similarly firmed, rising to $415-425/t fob. While Indonesia's PIM sold prilled urea in the low $390s/t fob.

MARKET DRIVERS

Gas, crude oil prices rise

Fresh strikes in the Middle East drove energy prices higher across the board. Natural gas prices in Europe moved to above €80/MWh to fresh recent highs. The TTF day-ahead price last hit these levels in December 2022. Brent crude oil futures moved up to around $106-107/bl by Thursday.

Chinese export allocations still pending

There was no sign of a potential issuance of Chinese urea export allocations. Many had expected an emergence either late last week or this week.

30-60 DAY OUTLOOK

Higher as things stand

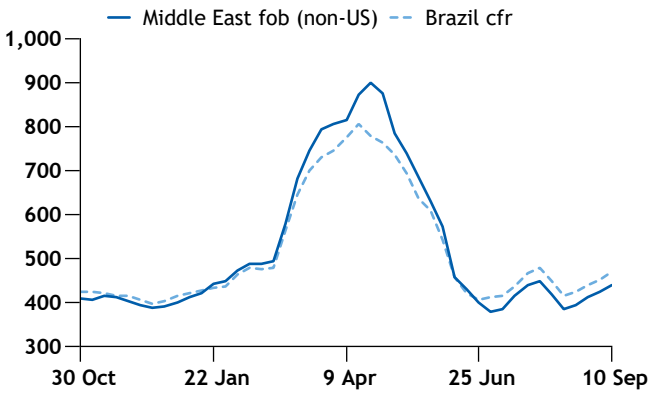
Prices are set to rise as long as the strait of Hormuz remains closed. There is a wall of demand to be met in the fourth quarter, led by Brazil, Europe, North America and India. Only China can upset the current demand-supply balance.

PRICES

Nitrogen daily prices			$/t
	10 Sep	09 Sep	±
Prilled urea			
China fob	355-365	355-365	nc
Granular urea			
Egypt fob (Europe)	510-510	505-505	+5.0
Middle East fob	440-450	440-448	+1.0
Nigeria fob	465-475	460-470	+5.0
Brazil cfr	465-485	460-475	+7.5
Nola fob $/st	460.0-465.0	450.0-455.0	+10.00
Nola MTD VWA $/st	446.79	445.58	+1.21
Ammonium sulphate			
fob China (standard caprolactam)	195-200	195-200	nc
cfr Brazil (compacted)	245-250	240-250	+2.5

For today's **weekly** price assessments, please go to page 2.

Granular urea: Middle East fob vs Brazil cfr $/t



DATA & DOWNLOAD INDEX

- Russia nitrogen exports
- India urea supply and demand
- Brazil urea import line-up
- India urea tenders
- Brazilian amsul vessel lineup

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PRICES

Nitrogen weekly prices	10 Sep	03 Sep	±	$/t
Prilled urea - fob bulk				
Black Sea	375-385	370-400	▼	
Baltic	370-380	365-395	▼	
Middle East	420-440	405-425	▲	
China	355-365	365-380	▼	
Brazil (cfr)	415-420	410-420	▲	
Mexico (cfr) east coast	427-442	400-426	▲	
Southeast Asia (cfr).	400-430	405-420	▲	
India (cfr)	390.00-394.00	390.00-394.00	◄ ►	
Granular urea - fob bulk				
Middle East all netbacks	311-452	296-435	▲	
Middle East US netback	327-452	304-434	▲	
Middle East Brazil netback	311-445	296-425	▲	
Middle East non-US netbacks	430-450	415-435	▲	
Iran	330-345	330-335	▲	
Egypt (Europe)	505-510	500-505	▲	
Egypt (non-Europe)	430-500	415-515	◄ ►	
Algeria	435-515	420-520	▲	
North Africa full range	430-515	415-520	▲	
Nigeria	455-475	430-465	▲	
China	410-420	400-410	▲	
Southeast Asia	415-425	405-420	▲	
Southeast Asia (cfr)	435-450	432-445	▲	
Geelong, Australia (A$/t fca)	750-770	760-780	▼	
Australia (cfr)	460-470	460-470	◄ ►	
Venezuela/Trinidad	240-418	225-400	▲	
Brazil (cfr)	455-485	440-465	▲	
Argentina (cfr)	490-500	475-485	▲	
Mexico (cfr) west coast	463-473	440-464	▲	
US Gulf (barge), $/st	440.0-465.0	420.0-449.0	▲	
US Gulf (cfr)	480-507	457-489	▲	
Nola barge weighted average Sep 26	450.93	437.47	▲	
Nola barge weighted average Oct 26	452.00	432.00	▲	
French Atlantic (fca), €/t	510-515	495-510	▲	
Baltic	415-440	395-420	▲	
Romania (cfr)	480-485	465-500	◄ ►	
Black Sea	455-470	445-465	▲	
India (cfr)	390.00-394.00	390.00-394.00	◄ ►	

Nitrogen weekly prices	10 Sep	03 Sep	±	$/t
Ammonium sulphate - bulk				
China fob (standard caprolactam)	190-200	190-194	▲	
China fob (compacted)	200-210	200-210	◄ ►	
NW Europe fob (granular caprolactam)	383-407	378-407	▲	
NW Europe fob (standard caprolactam)	308-313	302-314	▲	
Southeast Asia cfr (caprolactam)	220-225	210-220	▲	
Brazil cfr (standard caprolactam)	235-240	235-240	◄ ►	
Brazil cfr (compacted)	240-250	225-245	▲	
Ammonium chloride - bulk				
Southeast Asia cfr	135-150	140-150	▼	
Ammonium nitrate				
Baltic bulk fob	340-350	332-360	▼	
Black Sea bulk fob	340-370	340-380	▼	
UK (cif bagged), £/t	429-441	429-441	◄ ►	
CAN 27 Germany (cif inland), €/t	395-405	395-400	▲	
UAN (32%)				
Nola, $/st	320.00-350.00	310.00-335.00	▲	
Rouen 30% N fca, €/t	425-430	418-430	▲	
Black Sea fob	305-315	305-315	◄ ►	
Baltic fob (non-Russian)	~ 478-486	470-486	▲	
Baltic fob (Russian)	300-310	300-310	◄ ►	
Nutrient values				
Granular urea				
Middle East - all netbacks fob $/unit N	8.29	7.95	▲	
French Atlantic fca €/unit N	11.14	10.92	▲	
Prilled urea				
Baltic fob $/unit N	8.15	8.26	▼	
Southeast Asia cfr $/unit N	9.02	8.97	▲	
Nitrates				
AN bulk fob Baltic $/unit N	10.15	10.18	▼	
UAN 30pc N Rouen fca €/unit N	14.25	14.13	▲	
UAN 32pc Nola fob $/unit N	10.47	10.08	▲	
Ammonium Sulphate				
Brazil cfr (caprolactam) $/unit N	11.31	11.31	◄ ►	
Southeast Asia cfr caprolactam) $/unit N	10.60	10.24	▲	
Natural gas prices				
Henry Hub $/mn Btu	2.88	2.88	◄ ►	
TTF month ahead $/mn Btu	25.39	23.84	▲	
Urea Production Costs				
Northwest Europe fob	637.54	592.50	▲	
US Gulf fob	114.53	110.31	▲	

Urea freight

Loading	Destination	Tonnage	Rate ($/t) Low	Rate ($/t) High
Mideast Gulf	US Gulf	45	55	153
Mideast Gulf	Thailand	30	41	126
Mideast Gulf	Brazil	40	40	144
Baltic	Brazil	30	46	52
Nigeria	Brazil	30	23	34
Egypt	French bay	6	46	48
China	SE Asia	6	31	46
China	India	60	25	27
Algeria	Brazil	30	34	36
Algeria	US Gulf	30	33	34
Algeria	French bay	12	30	32
Baltic	EC Mexico	30	53	57
Baltic	WC Mexico	25	94	100
China	WC Mexico	25	52	54
UAN solution				
Klaipeda	Rouen	25 - 30	32	33

Sustainable Nitrogen prices, NW Europe	10 Sep	03 Sep	±	€/t cif inland
Carbon adjusted CAN 27 Germany (cif inland)	470.13	466.33	▲	
Ammonia import-based CAN	324.46	325.53	▼	
Carbon adjusted ammonia import-based CAN	398.41	398.11	▲	
BAT+ ammonia based CAN	516.66	497.57	▲	
Carbon adjusted BAT+ ammonia based CAN	545.56	525.94	▲	
No C ammonia based CAN	529.21	528.51	▲	

To learn more about the developing low-carbon nitrogen fertilizer market, please refer to the Argus Sustainable and Specialty Fertilizer service here.

Argus freight rates are assessed in consultation with producers, traders and buyers and freight broker service provider Nueva Seas.

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UREA: EUROPE

Baltic

Granular urea prices rose again, pushing up to $415-440/t fob, defined by firmer levels in the Americas.

The US is the premium target destination market, which is drawing some suppliers' attention away from Brazil, with fob levels at the high end of this week's assessment. Freight for larger vessels was indicated at $35-40/t from the Baltic to the US. While net backs from Brazil spanned the $410s-430s/t fob, with freight firming from the mid-$40s/t to low-$50s/t, but some saw levels even higher.

Meanwhile, Acron's maintenance in September-November, as reported last week, is set to reduce urea exports by 50pc in the period, which could equate to as much as 185,000-190,000t of lost granular urea in those three months. But there was no clarification from the producer.

Prilled urea prices tightened to $370-380/t fob, reflecting sales into Africa and levels to central America. A supplier sold 10,000t of prilled urea at $375-380/t fob to Brazil across several deals for loading this month and the start of October.

Black Sea

Granular urea prices rose to $455-470/t fob, reflecting firmer levels in local European markets and higher bids.

Sales into Romania were heard to have concluded at $455-460/t fob equivalent. A bid for a large lot of Turkmen granular urea was reported at $455/t fob, while bids into the Socar tender were higher, up to $470/t fob.

Azerbaijan's Socar closed its granular urea sales tender on 9 September, with levels heard at around $470/t fob at press time.

The producer was offering 30,000t in bulk from Batumi or 20,000t in one or multiple lots from Trabzon in Turkey, loading from the second half of September to the first half of October.

Turkmenistan's Garabogaz plant, with granular urea capacity of 1.1-1.2mn t/yr, is expected to be offline for maintenance from the end of September for around 20 days.

France

Sales of granular urea hovered around €510-515/t fca La Pallice, with deals of smaller-lots framing the upper end of the range.

But in general market activity eased from the previous week, as farmer purchasing interest remained subdued.

Stronger-than-expected French wheat export programmes for September and October have improved market sentiment and redirected some urea demand flows. But importers remain relatively cautious, awaiting greater clarity on price direction before returning to the market.

In fact, sentiment in the agricultural sector has improved as crop prices have strengthened. Growers are hoping higher grain values will help offset disappointing corn and sunflower yields reported in some regions.

Attention remains focused on rapeseed for the 2027 crop. Early concerns over a sharp reduction in planted area have moderated following improved weather conditions, but market participants continue to report uneven crop development and significant insect damage in emerged fields. As a result, farmers remain reluctant to commit forward rapeseed sales, while interest in marketing future wheat production has started to emerge.

Benelux

Offers for granular urea at Benelux seaports have risen to €515-525/t fca, but liquidity has remained thin.

Low water levels on the Rhine are reducing barge flows into Germany, and have forced importers to instead ship larger quantities from Ghent to other Benelux ports, as well as to German Baltic Sea ports.

Offers in Germany ranged €515-530/t fca for granular urea, with the higher end reflecting trans-shipped quantities from Ghent.

Poland

Granular urea is offered at around €515/t fca Szczecin, but buying interest remains weak and few transactions have been reported.

This compares with significant trading activity at €480-500/t fca just two to three weeks ago.

Higher freight rates, driven by increased bunker costs, have pushed up replacement values into the region. Market participants estimate replacement costs at around €520/t cfr before distributor margins, equivalent to roughly €535/t fca inland. Despite current market levels remaining below replacement cost, buyers have largely stayed on the sidelines

A freight enquiry was issued to ship 15,000t of urea from Arzew to Gdansk, Poland, loading 16-30 September.

Little EU funding available for drought response

Agriculture ministers' calls for additional support for drought-hit farmers facing liquidity pressures were met with an acknowledgement from EU agriculture commissioner Christophe Hansen that the bloc's annual €450mn agricultural crisis reserve has been exhausted for this year.

"There are also possibilities to derogate from certain

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requirements when farmers are facing exceptional circumstances," he said, pointing to derogations under the Nitrates Directive. Hansen said he had also written to member states to remind them of the "flexibilities" available under the Common Agricultural Policy (CAP) to provide liquidity support to farmers.

But Hansen said funding allocated to the Fertilisers Action Plan had depleted the remaining resources in the agricultural crisis reserve for this year. "We could eventually use the €450mn that we got for next year," he said, adding that it would be only a "drop in the ocean".

Read full story here.

Turkey

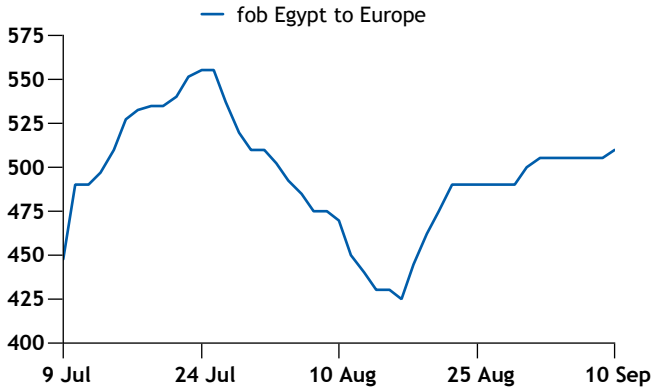
Chinese granular urea has mopped up considerable demand in recent weeks, with some estimating as much as 300,000t sold in the $470s/t cfr with varying credit terms, limiting interest in alternative origins.

Meanwhile, Russian prilled urea was on offer at $430-435/t cfr.

Romania

An importer is understood to have bought 6,000t of granular urea in the mid-$480s/t cfr, probably for shipment later this month from Black Sea ports.

Granular urea: fob Egypt to Europe daily



UREA: MIDDLE EAST AND AFRICA

Middle East

Granular urea was assessed at $430-450/t fob for the week.

Sabic AN sold 30,000t of granular urea in the mid-to-high $440s/t fob west coast on 9 September. The cargo will load in early October for an open destination. Sabic AN has been loading from the port of Yanbu in the past. The price marks an increase from a sale in the $410s/t fob west coast at the end of August for loading in September.

No vessel loaded with non-Iranian urea has been tracked crossing the strait of Hormuz. There are twelve vessels loaded with around 630,000t in the Mideast Gulf, after Sabic added a further two at Jubail in the past week, according to vessel-tracking data from Kpler.

Meanwhile, shipments from Oman have continued at a regular pace. There was a freight enquiry to ship 40,000t of urea from Sur for Pipavav, loading 22-24 September, likely for the Indian government's account.

Sabic AN approves FID for new urea, ammonia facility

Sabic AN's board has signed off on a final investment decision (FID) for its new 2.6mn t/yr urea facility, with commercial production set for the fourth quarter of 2030.

The facility will also include a 1.2mn t/yr ammonia capacity and post-combustion carbon capture unit. Construction is planned to start in the fourth quarter this year, according to a stock exchange filing.

The new facility will boost Sabic AN's annual urea capacity by just over half to 7.4mn t from 4.8mn t. The Saudi energy ministry approved the allocation of gas for the project in late March.

Saudi Arabia says several energy facilities attacked

A number of energy sector facilities in the southern region of Saudi Arabia came under attack in the early hours of Tuesday, according to the Saudi energy ministry, causing fires at a number of locations.

State-controlled Saudi Aramco temporarily halted operations at some of those facilities, the energy ministry said, as specialised emergency response teams work to contain the fire, secure the sites and assess the damage.

The attacks had resulted "in injuries of varying severity among several citizens and residents", it said.

The authorities are working to implement contingency measures to ensure business and operational continuity in accordance with company policy, the ministry said.

The energy ministry did not specify which facilities were targeted, or who was behind these latest attacks.

But the military spokesman for Yemen's Houthi rebels, Yahya Saree, has since issued a statement to say that the group had carried out "an extensive military operation" targeting Saudi Aramco in Abha, Najran and Jizan, the location of a key 400,000 b/d refinery that has been targeted by the Houthis in the past.

Saree said "dozens of ballistic missiles and drones" were launched at Saudi Arabia, and that the strikes had "caused significant damage" to the facilities.

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Iran

Granular urea was assessed at $330-345/t fob, framing latest bids and business confirmed out of the country.

MIS sold 45,000t of granular urea at $345/t fob for September shipment, in line with the official offer level announced by the producers for the week ending 11 September, up from $335/t fob last week.

Fellow producer Pardis closed a tender on 9 September to sell 30,000-60,000t of granular urea for September shipment, but no volumes were awarded.

Producers have received a wide range of bids in recent weeks, reflecting ongoing uncertainty over vessel transit through the Strait of Hormuz. As a result, deals have been heavily influenced by contractual terms related to passage risk, with negotiations often shaped by the allocation of freight and delivery liabilities.

Meanwhile, Hengam again stopped production at its 1.1mn t/ yr urea plant late last week, citing technical issues. Lordegan's 1.12mn t/ yr urea plant is still offline. Shiraz, KPIC, MIS, Khorasan and Razi are running their plants, but operating rates could not be confirmed with the producers.

Egypt

Granular urea was assessed at $505-510/t fob, framed by latest business out of the country.

Early in the week Mopco sold 5,000t of granular urea at $505/t fob Egypt, in line with the previous reported sales out of the country on 2 September. Another sale by fellow producer Helwan, for a total of 18,000t of granular urea, emerged on Thursday at $510/t fob in two separate deals to different trading firms. The urea will load in October and is likely headed to the European market.

Alexfert also sold 10,000t of granular urea at $515/t fob for loading in the first half of October, likely destined for Europe. But the deal emerged beyond publication time and was excluded from the assessment as a result.

Higher gas prices and expected robust demand from multiple European markets have lent support to producer offers, with targets indicated up to $520/t fob.

Algeria

Sorfert has sold a total of 8,000t of granular urea at $515/t fob.

The urea will load in late September to early October and will head to Europe.

Sentiment regarding urea prices in Europe remains strong, with buying interest solid in the past three weeks, underpinned by rising gas prices. Demand across several European markets is expected to strengthen in the coming weeks as importers and distributors secure remaining volumes for the next application season, with a significant share of demand still uncovered.

Nigeria

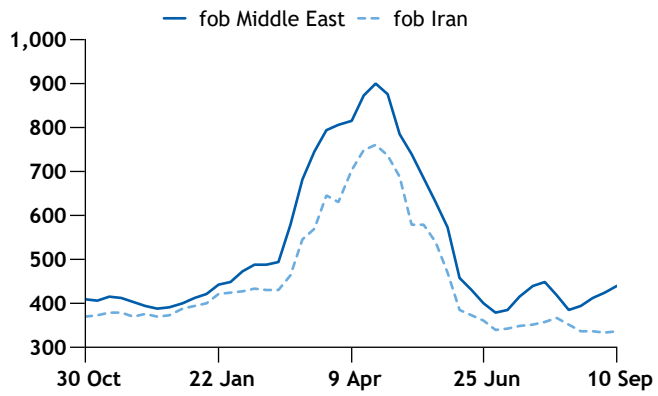
Granular urea was assessed at $455-475/t fob largely in line with levels in Brazil.

Offers hovered around $460-470/t fob Lekki, with offers fob Onne last heard around $480/t. But no business had emerged by publication time.

South Africa

Bids were largely absent from the market, with limited product reported available inland. Domestic prices were indicated at around $500/t fca.

Granular urea: fob Middle East non-US vs fob Iran



UREA: ASIA AND OCEANIA

China

Export prices for prilled urea were at $355-365/t fob, while granular urea was at $410-420/t fob.

Offers for prilled urea were considerably lower compared to granular, owing to limited regional interest for volumes, while granular urea prices were supported by demand from the west of Suez. Most export allocations remain with gas-based prilled urea producers, while other suppliers are sold out. Granular urea was heard offered up to $430/t fob by press time, but price ideas were largely up to $420/t fob.

The market is anticipating the third round of urea export allocations by end September, although no firm news has emerged.

China domestic

Domestic urea prices firmed up this week, supported by rising coal prices which raised production costs.

Domestic production rates are at 190,800t/day while fac-

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tory inventories have declined slightly to 1.52mn t.

- In Shandong, prilled urea prices rose to Yn1,800/t ex-works, while granular urea prices were at Yn1,910/t ex-works.
- In Hebei, prilled urea prices rose to Yn1,850/t ex-works. Zhengyuan is restarting its facility after a 20-day long turnaround.
- In Shanxi, prilled urea prices rose to Yn1,700/t ex-works, while granular urea prices rose to Yn1,850/t ex-works.
- In Jiangsu, granular urea prices rose to Yn1,950/t ex-works.

India

All vessels to RCF under its 11 August tender are understood to have been nominated, with all but two set to ship from China. Expectations are building for the next tender announcement later this month or in early October.

Southeast Asia

Granular urea prices in the region largely spanned $435-450/t cfr, while prilled urea prices were $400-430/t cfr.

Southeast Asian importers were mostly out of the market, as it is nearing the end of the current application season. Enquiries were largely for prompt loading small cargoes, and hand-to-mouth buying to balance inventories.

Granular urea prices rose to $415-425/t fob.

- Brunei: BFI closed a tender late last week to sell 30,000t of granular urea for loading in early October, with bids heard up towards $420/t fob. No confirmation was available from the producer. BFI has since raised granular urea offers to $430/t fob and above. The CI Democracy loaded at Muara with around 27,000t of granular urea on 7 September and is sailing for Geelong on the Australian east coast, according to vessel-tracker Kpler.
- Indonesia: Pupuk Indonesia sold 15,000t of prilled urea at around $392/t fob to a trading firm for second half of September loading. The producer subsequently sold an additional 6,000t of prilled urea at a similar price to another trader. The deals are understood to be private sales, but confirmation was available from the producer. Prilled urea offers were heard around $400/t fob by press time.

Australia

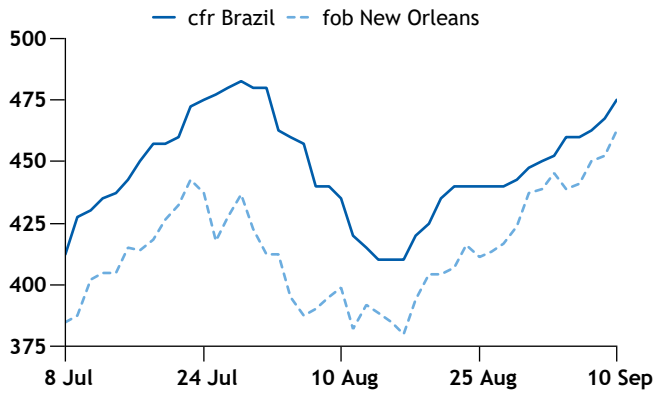
Granular urea was assessed softer on the week at A$750-770/t fca Geelong as demand remains slow and supply strong.

Most of Australia's grain growers and resellers are well covered for any granular urea demand and buying is likely to stay muted apart from for some summer crop requirements over the next few months.

There are 154,000t of urea in transit from southeast Asia to Australia's east coast for arrival in September, vessel tracking data from Kpler show, bringing the monthly total to 192,000t. Australia only imported 84,200t of urea in September 2025, trade data from the Australian Bureau of Statistics (ABS) show. This increase in urea volumes was offset by a 47pc drop on the year to 140,000t in August, ABS and Kpler data show.

This period of low demand has shielded Australian market participants from the increasing conflict in the Middle East, but if continued this would have run on impacts on the country's supply and prices.

Granular urea daily: cfr Brazil vs fob New Orleans



UREA: AMERICAS

Brazil

Granular urea prices rose further, pushing up to $455-485/t cfr for the week.

Levels jumped on Thursday, with suppliers hiking offers to $485-490/t cfr by press time for non-Chinese product, with some bids heard up to around $480/t cfr. Prices have risen sharply, reflecting a similar jump in the US at Nola, with Brent crude prices increasing and fighting between the US and Iran showing little sign of slowing. The daily assessment was $465-485/t cfr, accounting for Chinese product at the low end.

The ratio of front-month corn futures to urea cfr Brazil dipped further to 0.43:1 on 9 September, marking the lowest ratio since 11 August, as urea pushed higher. But that ratio is higher than the 0.34:1 averaged through this year so far and 0.41:1 in 2025. The higher the ratio, the more affordable urea is to the corn farmer.

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Brazilian urea imports down by 23pc in Jan-Aug

Brazil imported 2.82mn t of urea in January-August, down by nearly a quarter on last year's level, with the country's receipts largely lagging 2025 imports since January.

Russia accounted for 603,000t of urea imports in the period, up by a third on a year earlier, probably because of punitive measures on imports of Russian urea in Europe and the dwindling presence of Iranian and other Middle Eastern origins in Brazil since the start of the US-Iran war.

Imports of Nigerian urea fell by 38pc to 581,000t, largely driven by Nigerian producer Dangote's pivot towards Ethiopia earlier this year, as well as trading firms shipping tonnes to Europe rather than Brazil.

Receipts of urea from Oman, which some suppliers use as a more palatable origin in paperwork for Iranian product, fell by 40pc to 339,000t, clearly constricted by the fallout from the war in the Middle East. Imports from Qatar unsurprisingly crumbled by two-thirds to 168,000t.

Deliveries from Venezuela rose to 259,000t, up from 180,000t in the period last year. The frequency of shipments from Jose has improved since the regime change earlier this year, but Brazil was consistently a top outlet for Venezuelan urea regardless of the US issuing sanction waivers in March this year.

Meanwhile, imports from Algeria fell by nearly half on the year to 258,000t, mostly driven by trading firms focusing on North American markets, India and Europe. Receipts of Bolivian urea were 185,000t, down by 5pc. While receipts of Chinese urea jumped to 76,000t, up from just 13,000t in the period last year.

August imports were 509,000t, down from 613,000t in the month last year, with supply mostly coming from Russia, Nigeria, the Middle East, Algeria and the US.

Argentina/Uruguay

There was more activity and trading firms sold granular urea in the mid-to-high $490s/t to $500/t cfr Argentina.

At least two vessels loaded with Chinese urea are due to arrive in the coming weeks, with the *Ahsoka* due on 24 September and the *Epson Trader* set to arrive in early October, according to Kpler vessel-tracking data. The *Star Wave* is also due in from Oman in the Uruguayan port of Montevideo later this week before heading to San Lorenzo.

Mexico

Granular urea was assessed at $463-473/t cfr west coast, reflecting net forwards from latest prices out of China. But no fresh business was heard.

Central America

Incofe will close a tender on 16 September to buy up to 10,000t of prilled urea, 6,000t of granular urea, and 9,000t prilled AN and other fertilizers for shipment in the second of October to different Atlantic ports.

US

Urea prices sprung higher today alongside gains in crop markets and other commodities.

The daily barge price rose by $10/st to $460-465/st fob Nola with both ends of the range informed by September barges sold in the morning hours of the trading session. November and December barges traded at a discount from $453-455/st fob Nola compared with September.

The weekly Nola urea assessment rose by $18/st to $440-465/st fob Nola. The low end was based on prompt month trade on 4 September and the high end was underpinned by trade for the same loading period on 10 September.

Prompt month corn futures rose by 6¢/bushel to $5.14/bu today, regaining some losses from earlier in the week. Prompt month TTF, the European natural gas benchmark, rose to a fresh three-year and eight-month high of $28.05/mmBtu. Both markets have been bullish factors in the US fertilizer market. Higher crop prices have made nitrogen more affordable for farmers, while higher gas prices in Europe have increased expectations of production curtailments, which could draw urea imports away from the US.

Increased urea buying in the US has tightened availability at Nola and pushed prices higher, especially for September loading barges. The US market has maintained a premium to Brazil but is still struggling to attract imports.

FERTILIZER DERIVATIVES

Direct Hedge cash settled futures — 10 September 2026

Month	Bid	Offer	Mid	Basis
Urea (gran) fob barge NOLA (*short ton*)				
Sep	445	455	450	1.5kst
Oct	440	450	445	1.5kst
Nov	435	445	440	1.5kst
Urea (gran) fob Egypt (mt)				
Sep	490	515	503	5kmt
Oct	490	520	505	5kmt
Nov	490	520	505	5kmt
Urea (gran) fob Middle East (mt)				
Sep	385	425	405	5kmt
Oct	395	430	413	5kmt
Nov	395	430	413	5kmt
Urea (gran) cfr Brazil (mt)				
Sep	450	470	460	5kmt
Oct	485	495	490	5kmt
Nov	483	495	489	5kmt

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African volumes appear out of reach on paper even with September barges rising to $465/st fob Nola today. The US has become an attractive destination for Russian volumes based on fob values in the Baltic, but availability from Russia has been minimal, with upcoming plant maintenance in the country and sales commitments into Brazil.

Normally the Middle East might ship to the US but the global urea market remains deprived of the majority of supply from the region due to the ongoing conflict between the US-Israel and Iran.

AMMONIUM SULPHATE

China

Standard amsul weekly prices were indicated at $190-200/t fob, while daily prices were at $195-200/t fob.

Offers firmed gradually through the week to $195-200/t fob as suppliers raised prices citing tighter export availability. Some factories also halted offers, awaiting further clarity on the second round of export allocations after the 15 September deadline. But regional buying interest for amsul in southeast Asia is limited nearing the end of the nitrogen application season, and the increased availability of urea cargoes.

One supplier sold 10,000t of standard amsul at around $190/t fob for first-half October shipment to Europe.

Compacted amsul prices was assessed at $200-210/t fob, framed by latest deals and offers reported throughout the week to different markets. There was a reported deal of 10,000-20,000t of compacted amsul that traded in the $205-210/t fob range for September shipment to Brazil.

A river supplier reportedly sold 20,000t of compacted amsul at $200-208/t fob for first half October shipment to Brazil.

But uncertainty regarding customs inspections (CIQ) and availability, as well as emerging interest in Brazil and Europe, lent a firm sentiment to the market. Some suppliers increased their offers to $220-225/t fob buy-interest is yet to materialise at this level.

China domestic

Domestic caprolactam-grade amsul prices softened owing to the slow export market.

In Shanxi, steel-grade amsul prices fell to Yn870/t ex-works, equivalent to $181/t fob for compacted amsul.

In Inner Mongolia and Ningxia, steel-grade amsul prices fell to Yn770/t ex-works, equivalent to $159/t fob for compacted amsul.

In Shandong, caprolactam-grade amsul prices rose to Yn1,180/t ex-works, equivalent to $192/t fob.

In the south, Hengyi and Baling raised prices to Yn1,030/t ex-works.

MMA-grade amsul prices fell to Yn935/t ex-works in Shandong, equivalent to $156/t fob, while LFP-grade amsul prices fell to Yn960/t ex-works in Hubei, equivalent to $158/t fob.

Average operating rates of caprolactam rose to 69pc, owing to the restart of Tianchen's plant and rise in operating rates from Luxi.

Southeast Asia

Standard amsul prices firmed slightly to $220-225/t cfr owing to higher loading prices. But fresh buying demand is limited, as most regions are nearing the end of the application season. Freight for a 6,000-8,000t bulk vessel from China to Thailand was indicated at $36-43/t, while freight for a 20,000t bulk vessel from China to southeast Asia was in the low-$30s/t.

Indonesia

Pupuk Indonesia closed a tender to buy 180,000t of caprolactam-grade standard amsul for delivery from October to December 2026. Pupuk Indonesia has requested that offers be submitted on a formula price with a variable discount. Discounts ranging from $15-20/t were heard, market participants said, although this was not confirmed by the companies involved.

India

Fact has yet to open offers under its 27 August tender to buy up to 600,000t of standard caprolactam-grade amsul over a two-year period. The tender was initially set to close on 18 August but the closing date was postponed twice.

Northwest Europe

Standard caprolactam-grade amsul was assessed at €265-270/t fob northwest Europe and granular amsul was assessed at €330-350/t fob northwest Europe.

Offers of standard amsul were indicated at $270/t fob, with latest business concluded last week at $260/t fob for a small lot. But interest was comparatively muted on the week, higher gas prices and a firm market sentiment supported higher levels. The focus was on the granular market this week, following news that German producer Domo will shut its units in October after failing to find an investor.

A northwest European producer reported an uptick in sales after the news broke earlier in the week, particularly from German buyers. Some barge-loads of granular amsul were sold at €330/t fob northwest Europe for October shipment. Another Baltic producer also received rising enquiries but had no granular product to offer until end November.

Meanwhile, EU's tariff-free amsul quota has reached 27pc, basis latest customs data. Allocations of amsul have jumped to 110,000t from an overall quota of 413,000t. At least three

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more vessels are currently heading to Europe, and are expected to arrive in late September or early October.

Brazil

The weekly compacted amsul prices were assessed at $240-250/t cfr and the daily compacted amsul price was assessed at $245-250/t cfr.

Some business was heard at $240-245/t cfr southern ports early in the week. Bids shifted higher throughout the week from $235/t cfr to $245/t cfr later in the week.

Later in the week, most offers were indicated from $250-255/t cfr while some suppliers stepped back waiting for clarity regarding customs inspections (CIQ).

East Africa

Notional offers of Chinese standard amsul were indicated at around $260-265/t cfr but bid interest is at least $40/t lower.

South Africa

Sales for standard and compacted amsul were reported at $255-260/t cfr for a September loading vessel loading. But only limited volumes were available for sale this week. The vessel is set to bring in 35,000t of compacted and 5,000t of standard amsul and both grades were sold at the same range.

Spot offers for standard amsul this week were indicated higher at $270-280/t cfr, as availability out of China continues to tighten.

Mexico

Buyers are in the market checking prices and have received non-Chinese offers of granular amsul spanning $390/t cfr east coast to around $470/t cfr west coast. But the offers were too high and received little buy-side interest.

US

Ammonium sulphate activity largely quieted over the week following fresh sales across the northern US last week.

Amsul barge prices at Nola ticked higher despite no reported spot business. Supply appears tight heading into the fourth quarter, with many producers comfortable with their sales books and showing little urgency to pursue additional sales.

Advansix pulled offers on Tuesday after prior-week sales were supported by higher urea and grain prices. Upriver demand strengthened across the US, especially in the northeast and Northern Plains, where delivered prices reached $400-430/st last week. Buyers have focused on barges loading before river-close cut-off dates or in the first quarter.

Many market participants are waiting for more clarity on the fourth-quarter Tampa sulfur settlement before issuing new offers. However, it remains unconfirmed when Advansix's new prices will be released.

The *Golden Isle* is carrying about 37,000t of amsul from Belgium to Mobile, Alabama, and likely Nola, according to vessel-tracking application Kpler and market sources.

AMMONIUM CHLORIDE

China

Offers for standard AC were indicated at $115/t fob. A supplier is offering granular white AC at $136/t fob in containers. Some suppliers have also halted offers as they are sold out of export allocations.

Domestic dry ammonium chloride prices mostly rose.

In Henan, standard AC prices were at Yn400-440/t ex-works.

In Jiangsu, prices were at Yn480-500/t ex-works.

In Hubei, prices were at Yn480/t ex-works.

Southeast Asia

Delivered prices of standard AC to southeast Asia rose to $155-160/t cfr, supported by rising freight costs.

Meanwhile, container offers for granular AC have risen to $180/t cfr for September loading.

Freight rates for a 20,000t vessel from China to southeast Asia are in the low-$30/t, while freight for a 6,000t vessel from China to southeast Asia firmed to $43-46/t.

AMMONIUM NITRATES

Germany

CAN 27 prices have firmed slightly, up by €2.50/t to €395-405/t cif inland.

Producers aimed for sales at €400-410/t cif inland for much of the week, but wholesaler buying was constrained amid lacklustre offtake from retailers and farmers. Business below €400/t cif inland was still possible from one producer.

But the latest surge in European gas prices above €80/MWh caused the market to refocus today. At least one supplier withdrew offers, with new levels not emerging by press time. Another producer raised offers to €425/t cif inland in Benelux, but offers also emerged at €410/t cif inland in Germany. Trade emerged as high as €405/t cif inland.

The gap between theoretical production costs and CAN prices is rising. At an Ice TTF front-month price of €81/MWh, the gas cost to produce CAN lies between €400-450/t depending on efficiency of the unit, not including ancillary costs.

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Baltic

A supplier sold 8,000t of AN in the low $340s/t fob to the US for September shipment. Prices were largely indicated in the $340s/t fob, pulling this week's assessment lower, pressured by rising freight costs.

Another sale of 15,000t of CAN was concluded in the mid $260s/t fob Baltic for the Turkish markets. Offers moved up to $290/t fob for October shipment for Africa. But no business was confirmed at this level by reporting time.

South Africa

A trading firm is offering Russian CAN at $380-385/t cfr. Inland prices were indicated at around $425/t fca.

Sasol to sell nitrates business

South African chemical and fertilizer producer Sasol signed an agreement on 9 September to sell its nitrates business to Chilean explosives manufacturer Enaex.

Sasol's nitrates business is in South Africa and includes plants in Secunda and Sasolburg that convert ammonia to feedstock for fertilizers and explosives. The company is expected to retain a 23pc stake in the venture.

The sale is subject to regulatory approval before being finalised. No timeline was provided.

UAN SOLUTIONS

China

The UAN prices still remained stable at Yn1,720/t ex-works in Shandong.

A northern supplier still held offers at $290/t fob but no deal emerged.

France

More UAN 30 business emerged this week at €425-427/t fca Rouen, but activity was, like urea, slower compared to last week.

Several suppliers have now increased offers up to €430-435/t fca Rouen. But no business was confirmed at this level.

The *Schwyz*, carrying around 37,000t of UAN from Trinidad and Tobago is expected to arrive to Ghent later this month, before heading onwards to Rouen and the UK.

Baltic

UAN prices were assessed stable at $300-310/t fob framed by business concluded to the East coast of the US.

Benelux

Offers for UAN 30 have risen to €430/t fca for locally produced product, but imported UAN was also on offer at €420/t fca.

The vessel Schwyz is en route to Belgium's Ghent, loaded with 37,000t of UAN from Trinidad and Tobago, with arrival expected on 21 September. Some of the cargo is also destined for the UK and France.

US

The Nola UAN price moved higher in reaction to continued demand for forward loading interest along the US river system.

The Nola barge price increased by $12.50/st to $320-350/st fob this week. The low end of the range was informed by bids and netbacks from truck trade at Cincinnati. Offers for a December barge and January loading barge trade done on a delivered basis this week aligned with the high end of the range. Most weekly UAN assessments started including Nola include fill and pre-pay markets in July when summer fill programs began.

A barge loading at Nola traded at $330/st fob on 4 September while other indications pointed to values around $335/st fob.

A vessel from Trinidad and Tobago, the Solar Madelein, delivered 21,000 metric tonnes (t) of UAN to Nola on 6 September, according to bill of lading data.

Distributors have been purchasing tows from Nola loading in the fourth and first quarters over the last two weeks to meet increasing forward demand from farmers and retailers, largely stemming from prior gains in crop markets. Higher corn prices have allowed farmers to afford fertilizer purchases further in advance of the spring season compared to a year-ago, which has extended sales books for producers and distributors.

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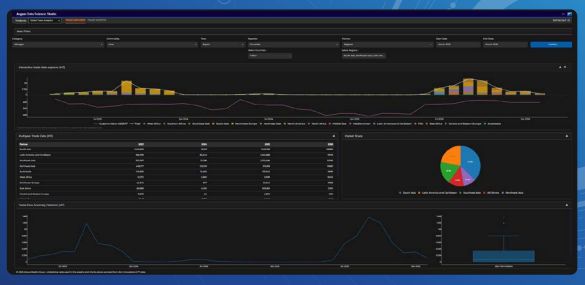
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